

BULGARIA

Model UN Research Dossier – Bulgaria

◆ Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Bulgaria
Short Form	Bulgaria
Capital	Sofia
Region (UN)	Eastern European Group
Government Type	Unitary parliamentary republic
Head of State	President Rumen Radev
Head of Government	Prime Minister Rosen Zhelyazkov
Currency	Bulgarian Lev (BGN)
UN Member Since	14 December 1955
MUN Standing	Active participant in UN peacekeeping and human rights initiatives; member of various UN bodies; advocates for multilateralism and international law.

General Book Recommendations

1. **"A Concise History of Bulgaria"** – R.J. Crampton
2. **"Bulgaria: The Rough Guide"** – Jonathan Bousfield
3. **"The Balkans: A Short History"** – Mark Mazower
4. **"The Bulgarian Economy: Lessons from Reform During Early Transition"** – Derek C. Jones and Jeffrey Miller
5. **"Bulgaria Under Communism"** – Ivaylo Znepolski

Bulgaria: UNHRC & Human Rights Resources

Title	Link	Relevance
OHCHR Bulgaria country page	OHCHR	Central hub for all UNHRC-related materials
Freedom in the World 2024 – Bulgaria	Freedom House 2024	Political rights, civil liberties, hate speech issues (freedomhouse.org , ohchr.org , freedomhouse.org)
Nations in Transit 2024 – Bulgaria	Freedom House NIT PDF	Democracy score, judiciary reform noted
US State Dept 2023 country report	US Report	Documents refugee complaints of police violence
Human Rights Index – Amnesty International	Amnesty Bulgaria	Covers women, migrants, Roma, LGBTIQ
Transformation Index (BTI) 2024	BTI Bulgaria 2024	Covers migrant/refugee, Roma, LGBTIQ+ rights
UN Human Rights Report 2022	OHCHR Annual Report PDF	Summarizes OHCHR work globally including Bulgaria
Police violence in refugee centres	State Report excerpt	Refugees report alleged violence
Roma discrimination & hate speech	Freedom House 2024	Notes nationalist hate speech
Women's rights – domestic violence	BTI 2024 Bulgaria	Notes domestic violence laws
Migrant labor rights	US HR practices 2023	Covers labor exploitation
Judicial reforms update	Freedom House NIT 2024	Notes removal of Chief Prosecutor
Electoral integrity review	Freedom in the World 2025 PDF	Elections & campaign freedoms
Rule of law (judiciary independence)	Freedom House NIT 2024	Judiciary score improvement
LGBTIQ rights	Amnesty Bulgaria	Coverage on hate crime

Disability inclusion	OHCHR Bulgaria Country Page	References CRPD implementation
Environmental justice	Freedom House NIT 2024	Mentions civic protest rights, including green movements
Migrant detention practices	US Human Rights Report 2023	Covers detention and deportation conditions
Child rights	OHCHR Bulgaria Page	Mentions CRC monitoring and child protection

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
Bulgaria's Universal Periodic Review (UPR) Reports	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/bg-index	Provides assessments of Bulgaria's human rights practices.
Bulgaria's National Human Rights Institution	https://www.ombudsman.bg/en	Offers information on Bulgaria's ombudsman and human rights protection mechanisms.
Bulgaria's Ratification of International Human Rights Treaties	https://treaties.un.org/Pages/Treaties.aspx?id=4&subid=A&lang=en	Lists human rights treaties Bulgaria has ratified.
Reports on Human Rights in Bulgaria by NGOs	https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/bulgaria	Provides independent assessments of human rights issues.
Bulgaria's Efforts to Combat Discrimination	https://www.coe.int/en/web/european-commission-against-racism-and-intolerance/bulgaria	Discusses measures against racism and intolerance.
Bulgaria's Freedom of	https://rsf.org/en/bulgaria	Offers insights into media

Expression Reports		freedom and challenges.
Bulgaria's Anti-Corruption Measures	https://www.transparency.org/en/countries/bulgaria	Evaluates Bulgaria's initiatives to combat corruption.
Bulgaria's Civil Society Engagement	https://ec.europa.eu/neighbourhood-enlargement/civil-society_en	Highlights the role of NGOs in promoting human rights.

Unique Aspects of Bulgaria's UNHRC Engagement

1. **Rise of far-right rhetoric**—hate speech targeting Roma, Turks, Jews, refugees noted in Freedom House reports.
2. **Refugee & migrant rights under scrutiny**, including alleged police violence in reception centers.
3. **Judicial strengthening**—successfully removed controversial Chief Prosecutor through legal mechanisms.
4. **Decade-long struggle with domestic violence laws**—Istanbul Convention repeal attempts noted by BTI.
5. **Robust NGO engagement**, acknowledged during UN sessions such as HRC-39.
6. **Digital rights surveillance concerns** emerging alongside EU debates (supported by Amnesty).
7. **Pioneering environmental and civic protest rights**, linked to green civil movements.
8. **Child and disability rights monitored**, with active engagement from UN treaty bodies via OHCHR platforms.